Sohyeon Kim

PhD Candidate | Department of Recreation, Sport and Tourism
College of Applied Health Sciences, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
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EDUCATION

May 2027 (Expected) **PhD in Recreation, Sport and Tourism**
Dissertation (*working title*): Understanding Online Sexual Behavior as Leisure: A Mixed Methods Study on the Profiles, Motivations, and Experiences
Committee Members: Dr. Liza Berdychevsky (Chair), Dr. Toni Liechty, Dr. Cabral Bigman-Galimore, & Dr. Cherie M. Avent

2020 **MS in Leisure and Tourism Sciences**
Kyonggi University, South Korea
Thesis Title: Influence of Perceived Risk and Fear of Crime on International Solo Travel Intention

2018 **BS in (1) Tourism and Recreation, (2) Sport Tourism**
Kyonggi University, South Korea

PUBLICATIONS

PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL ARTICLES

Kim, S. & Berdychevsky, L. (2025). Cybersex as leisure: Socio-demographic and socio-psychological profiling of the (non)participants in online sexual activities. *Leisure Sciences*, 1-26. https://doi.org/10.1080/01490400.2025.2503974

Dariotis, J. K., Eldreth, D., **Kim, S.**, Berdychevsky, L., Park, Y., & Smith, R. (2025). "COVID was a worldwide pandemic that caused trauma for everyone… There were also 'silver-linings'" – A qualitative analysis of adult and youth perspectives on COVID-19 thorns and silver linings. *American Journal of Qualitative Research, 9*(2), 176-206. https://doi.org/10.29333/ajqr/16281

Kim, S. & Lee, W. S. (2019). Network text analysis of medical tourism in newspapers using text mining: The South Korea case. *Tourism Management Perspectives*, 31, 332-339. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tmp.2019.05.010

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVISION

Kim, S. & Berdychevsky, L. (under revision). Sex as leisure view, sexual comfort, and cybersex repertoires with a primary partner, known non-partner(s), and stranger(s). *Journal of Leisure Research*.

BOOK CHAPTERS

Kim, S. & Berdychevsky, L. (accepted for publication). Navigating sex tech in hospitality through social, institutional, and legal perspectives. In N. Carr & L. Berdychevsky (Eds.), *Sex in hospitality: The good, the bad, and the ugly.* CABI.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

PEER-REVIEWED NATIONAL/INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCES

Kim, S. & Berdychevsky, L. (2026, November 9-13). *Intrinsic Motivations, Facilitating Factors, and Biopsychosocial Benefits of Online Sexual Activities.* 2026 Annual Conference of the Society for the Scientific Study of Sexuality, Virtual.

Kim, S. & Berdychevsky, L. (2026, February 11-13). *Online Sexual Behavior: Exploring the Motivations and Leisure Qualities.* 2026 The Academy of Leisure Sciences Conference, Philadelphia, PA.

Kim, S. & Berdychevsky, L. (2026, February 11-13). *Sex as Leisure and Sexual Comfort in the Digital World.* 2026 The Academy of Leisure Sciences Conference, Philadelphia, PA.

Kim, S. & Berdychevsky, L. (2025, March 5-7). *Cybersex as Leisure: Profiling the Participants in Online Sexual Activities.* 2025 The Academy of Leisure Sciences Conference, Pittsburgh, PA.

Kim, S., Berdychevsky, L., Nimrod, G., Eldreth, D., Sloane, S., & Dariotis, J. K. (2025, March 5-7). *Innovation in Leisure as a Coping Mechanism with the COVID-19 Pandemic*. 2025 The Academy of Leisure Sciences Conference, Pittsburgh, PA.

Eldreth, D., Dariotis, J. K., Sloane, S., **Kim, S.**, Berdychevsky, L., Smith, R. L., & Noor, I. (2024, October 27-30). *Perceived acute and residual effects of COVID-19 and public health mandates on childcare providers and child development*. The 2024 American Public Health Association Annual Meeting and Expo, Minneapolis, MN.

Kim, S., Berdychevsky, L., Nimrod, G., Eldreth, D., Sloane, S., & Dariotis, J. K. (2024, May 15-18). *Innovation in Leisure as a Coping Mechanism with the COVID-19 Pandemic*. The 20th International Congress of Qualitative Inquiry Conference, Champaign-Urbana, IL.

Dariotis, J. K., Eldreth, D., Sloane, S., Noor, I., Ward, S., **Kim, S.**, Berdychevsky, L., & Smith, R. L. (2024, May 15-18). *Vaccine Update Personas and Relevant Health Communication Strategies.* The 20th International Congress of Qualitative Inquiry Conference. Champaign-Urbana, IL.

Kim, S., Yan, X., & Berdychevsky, L. (2024, January 31-February 2). *Sexual Health Education for Leisure Travelers*. 2024 The Academy of Leisure Sciences Conference, New Orleans, LA.

Dariotis, J. K., Eldreth, D., Sloane, S., Noor, I., Ward, S., **Kim, S.**, Berdychevsky, L., & MMCOVID Investigators (2023, November 12-15). *Anticipated HIV Vaccine Uptake in a Post-COVID World and Public Health Messaging Implications*. 2023 American Public Health Association Annual Meeting and Expo. Atlanta, GA.

Kim, S. (2018, July 4-6). *The travel adaptation process of companion dog owners: A grounded theory approach*. The 84th Tourism Sciences Society of Korea Seoul International Conference, Seoul, South Korea.

Kim, S. & Lee, W. S. (2018, April 27). *Keyword analysis for medical tourism among newspapers using text mining: The South Korea case*. The 2018 Fall Conference of Academic Society of Event & Convention, Seoul, South Korea.

CAMPUS & REGIONAL PRESENTATIONS/WORKSHOPS

(* indicates undergraduate student mentee)

Choudhry, R.*, Langunas, A.*, Estrada, D.*, & **Kim, S.** (2026, April 30). *The Effects of Fitness Tracker Apps & Wearables on College Students' Self-Reported Anxiety*. 2026 Undergraduate Research Symposium, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Champaign-Urbana, IL.

Kim, S. & Berdychevsky, L. (2025, May 2). *Socio-Demographic & Socio-Psychological Profiling of (Non)Participants in Online Sexual Activities*. Center for Gender and Sex in Health Spring 2025 Workshop, Grainger College of Engineering, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Champaign-Urbana, IL.

Grossen, C.*, **Kim, S.**, & Berdychevsky, L. (2024, April 25). *Online Adult Entertainment Platforms: Understanding Motivations and Differences between the Users and Non-users.* 2024 Undergraduate Research Symposium, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Champaign-Urbana, IL.

Grossen, C.*, **Kim, S.**, & Berdychevsky, L. (2024, April 24). *Online Adult Entertainment Platforms: Understanding Motivations and Differences between the Users and Non-users.* 2024 Applied Health Sciences Research Expo, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Champaign-Urbana, IL.

HONORS AND AWARDS

2025 **Allen V. Sapora Research Award**, Department of Recreation, Sport and Tourism, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

2024 – 2026 **Conference Presentation Travel Award**, Department of Recreation, Sport and Tourism, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

2018 – 2019 **Graduate Research Fellowship**, Kyonggi University

2018 **Best Paper Award**, Graduate Student Research Paper Competition, The 84th Tourism Sciences Society of Korea Seoul International Conference

2018 **Best Undergraduate Thesis Award**, Department of Tourism and Recreation, Kyonggi University

2017 **Second Prize**, Public Big Data Competition (Data Visualization Track), National Information Society Agency (NIA), South Korea

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

2022 – 2023 **Graduate Research Assistant**
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
- Supervisor: Dr. Liza Berdychevsky

2018 – 2020 **Graduate Research Assistant**
Kyonggi University
- Supervisor: Dr. Won Seok Lee

2017 **Undergraduate Research Assistant**
Tourism Research Institute, Kyonggi University

TEACHING & MENTORING EXPERIENCES

2025 – 2026 **Instructor of Record**
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
- RST 370: Research Methods & Analysis (Fall 2025, Spring 2026)

2024 – 2026 **Graduate Teaching Assistant**
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
- RST 242: Nature and American Culture (Spring 2024)
- RST 350/570: Tourism and Culture (Spring 2024)
- RST 370: Research Methods & Analysis (Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2026)
- RST 465: Event Implementation in RST (Spring 2025)

2024 – 2026 **Undergraduate Research Mentor**
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
- **Reeha Choudhry, America Langunas, & Dulce Estrada Flores** (2025 – 2026), "Health Technologies and Anxiety Among College Students" (Presented at UIUC Undergraduate Research Symposium, 2026)
- **Claire Grossen** (2024), "Sexual Behavior in Digital Contexts" (Students Pursuing Applications, Research, and Knowledge Program [SPARK] & James Scholar Honors Program; Presented at UIUC Undergraduate Research Symposium & Applied Health Sciences Research Expo, 2024)

SERVICE

DISCIPLINARY SERVICE

2026 **Abstract Reviewer**, The Academy of Leisure Sciences Conference

2025 – 2026 **Ad-Hoc Reviewer**, Leisure Sciences

2025 **Moderator**, The Academy of Leisure Sciences Conference

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

2026 **Awareness Month Committee Member**
Women's Resources Center, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

2025 – 2026 **Ad-Hoc Judge**
Undergraduate Research Symposium, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

2024 – 2025 **Global Educator**
International Student and Scholar Services, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

COMMUNITY SERVICE

2025 **Ad-Hoc Judge,** IJAS State Exposition, Illinois Junior Academy of Science

CERTIFICATES

2025 **Community Engaged Scholar Certificate**
We CU, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

2024 **Certificate in Foundations of Teaching**
Center for Innovation in Teaching & Learning (CITL), University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign